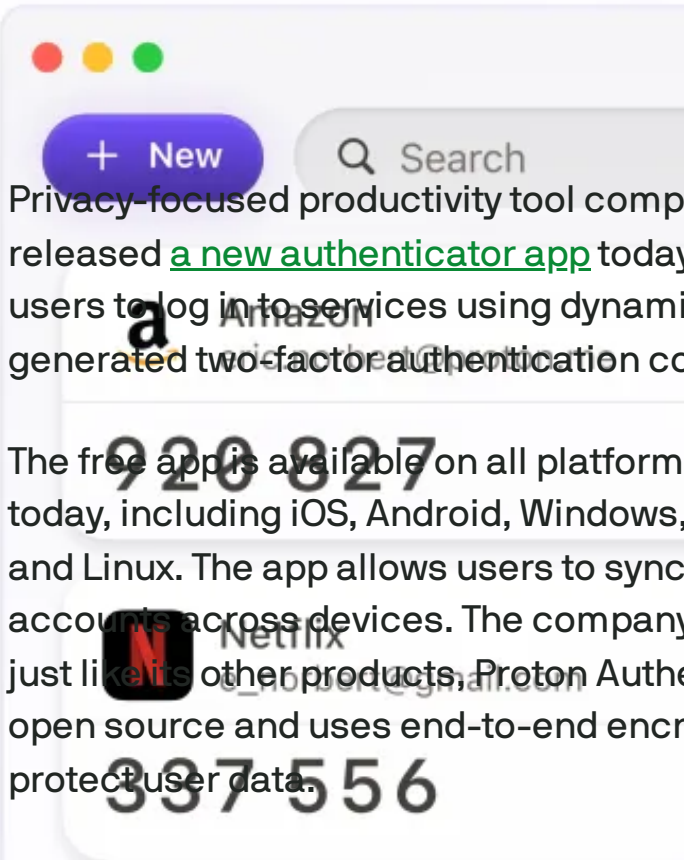


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APPS



Proton releases a new
app for two-factor
authentication



Privacy-focused productivity tool company Proton released [a new authenticator app](#) today, allowing users to log into services using dynamically generated two-factor authentication codes.

The free app is available on all platforms starting today, including iOS, Android, Windows, macOS, and Linux. The app allows users to sync codes and accounts across devices. The company said that just like its other products, Proton Authenticator is open source and uses end-to-end encryption to protect user data.

Users can easily import login codes from other authentication apps, the company said. Plus, the app automatically backs up codes and also works without any internet connection.

	 Proton Authenticator	 Google Authenticator	 Authy	 Microsoft Authenticator	 Duo
Open source	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
Encrypted sync	✓	✗	✗	✓	✓
No ads or tracking	✓	✗	✗	✗	✓
Platform availability	Android iOS Windows Mac Linux	Android iOS	Android iOS	Android iOS	Android iOS
Direct export	✓	✓	✗	✗	✗
Offline support	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓

IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON

“Two-factor authentication is essential for everyone – not just those who care about their privacy. Proton Authenticator is built for anyone

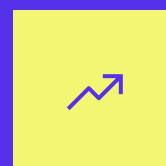
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who wants a secure, transparent, and convenient way to protect their accounts,” Eamonn Maguire, head of Account Security at Proton, said in a statement.

“We believe strong security should never come at the cost of your convenience or privacy. That’s why we’ve developed Proton Authenticator: to give users peace of mind that their 2FA codes are available wherever they need them, without relying on Google or Microsoft. We’re putting users firmly in control not only over their data, but the way they access their online accounts,” he added.

Two-factor authentication using an app provides users with an extra layer of security to prevent attackers from taking over accounts. While SMS-based two-factor authentication is another option, it is often vulnerable to SIM swapping attacks, in which attackers can intercept your calls and messages.

Proton is on a product-releasing spree. Earlier this week, the company launched [a privacy-focused AI chatbot named Lumo](#), which doesn’t keep any conversation records or use user data to train models.

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Ivan Mehta

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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SECURITY



Proton launches its password manager Proton Pass

A couple of months after [unveiling Proton Pass](#), Proton — the company behind end-to-end encrypted email service Proton Mail — is officially launching its password manager to everyone. As a reminder, Proton Pass is an end-to-end encrypted password manager for individuals and (soon) families.

Everybody should use a password manager as it helps you use a sophisticated password for every website and service where you have an account. This way, when a service faces a data breach, your accounts remain relatively safe. You can change your password on the targeted site and move on.

IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON

There are several options when it comes to password managers. Some enterprise-grade password managers like [1Password](#) and [Dashlane](#) offer many features, such as the ability to store documents and receive security alerts when there's a new data breach that could affect you.

Web browsers, such as Google Chrome and Mozilla Firefox, also have their own built-in password managers. They are more limited than dedicated products, but they are free. Apple's operating systems (macOS, iOS, etc.) also offer a built-in password manager that works really well for people who like Apple's ecosystem.

I played around with a beta version of Proton Pass, and it offers all the basic features that you would

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expect from a password manager. It's available as a browser extension on desktop (Chrome, Firefox, Edge and Brave) and the company also has mobile apps for iOS and Android.

When you browse the web on desktop, Proton Pass takes over from the default password manager in your browser. For instance, if you sign in to your email account, Proton Pass will prompt you to save your credentials in Proton's password manager. If you create a new account, Proton Pass can generate a unique password for you.

On the iPhone, Proton Pass can be used to autofill passwords in Safari and mobile apps. Your logins and passwords are automatically synchronized across devices.



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Everything you store in Proton Pass is end-to-end encrypted, including passwords (obviously), but also email addresses, URLs and notes. Proton itself cannot decrypt your user data as they don't have your user key.

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The company plans to open source Proton Pass so that security experts can verify the security model. There will be security audits, security reports and a bug bounty program as well.

In addition to login information, Proton Pass users can store generation codes for one-time passwords so that the password manager can become their two-factor authenticator. Users can also create notes for sensitive information that aren't related to online services, such as credit card information and Social Security numbers.

Proton Pass is the result of [the acquisition of SimpleLogin](#), an email alias startup, as the SimpleLogin team worked on Proton Pass. Proton is taking advantage of SimpleLogin's existing product as users can create email aliases if they don't want to share their real email address. Incoming emails are redirected to their Proton Mail inbox. If you don't need that alias anymore, you can delete it and the email alias will stop working.

Overall, Proton Pass doesn't have all the bells and whistles of 1Password, but it's a solid password manager. A native desktop app would be nice. Credit card autofilling would be useful too. But the basic version of Proton Pass is free with support for multiple devices.

Users can also get a premium subscription, which includes unlimited email aliases instead of 10 and the two-factor authentication feature I mentioned earlier. It will soon also include the ability to create shared vaults so that users can safely share passwords with family members and friends. If you're already a Proton subscriber, the premium features for Proton Pass are included in Proton's [Unlimited](#) and [Family](#) plans. Otherwise, the premium version of Proton Pass will cost \$2.99 to \$4.99 per month based on the subscription length.

If you are using Proton Mail as your main email address, Proton Pass could be particularly compelling, as the email alias feature integrates seamlessly with your Proton Mail email address. Proton Pass could also quickly become a way to attract new users to the Proton ecosystem with its free offering. The company recently surpassed [100 million user accounts](#).

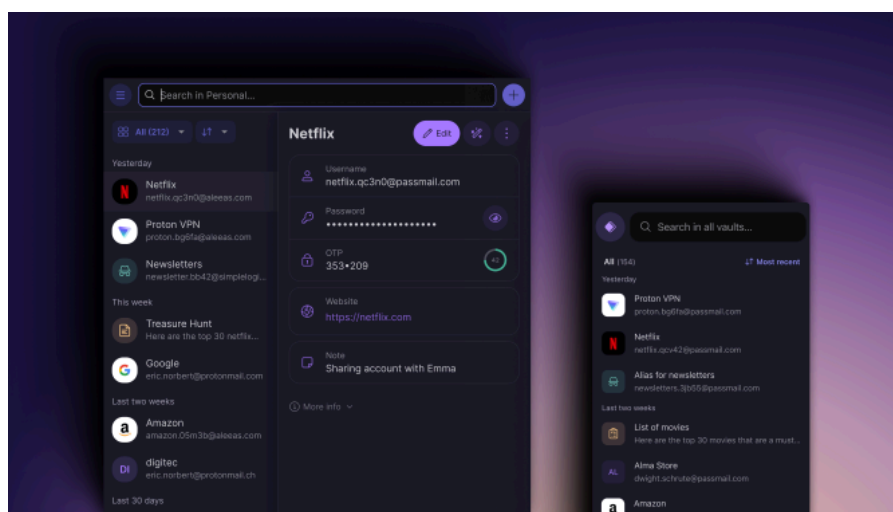


IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON

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 **Romain Dillet**
Senior Reporter |    

Romain Dillet was a Senior Reporter at TechCrunch until April 2025. He has written over 3,500 articles on technolo...

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Ivan Mehta — 5:49 AM PDT · July 23, 2025

IMAGE CREDITS: PROTON.ME

Privacy-focused productivity tools maker Proton on Wednesday released its AI assistant, called Lumo, which it says prioritizes protecting user data.

The company says the chatbot keeps no logs of your conversations, has end-to-end encryption for storing chats, and offers a ghost mode for conversations that disappear as soon as you close the window.

Available via a [web client](#), as well as [Android](#) and [iOS](#) apps, Lumo doesn't require you to have an account to use the chatbot and ask questions. You can upload files to have the chatbot answer

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questions about them, and if you have a [Proton Drive](#) account, you can connect it with Lumo to access files stored in the cloud. While the chatbot has access to the web, it might not find you the latest results if you use it to search.

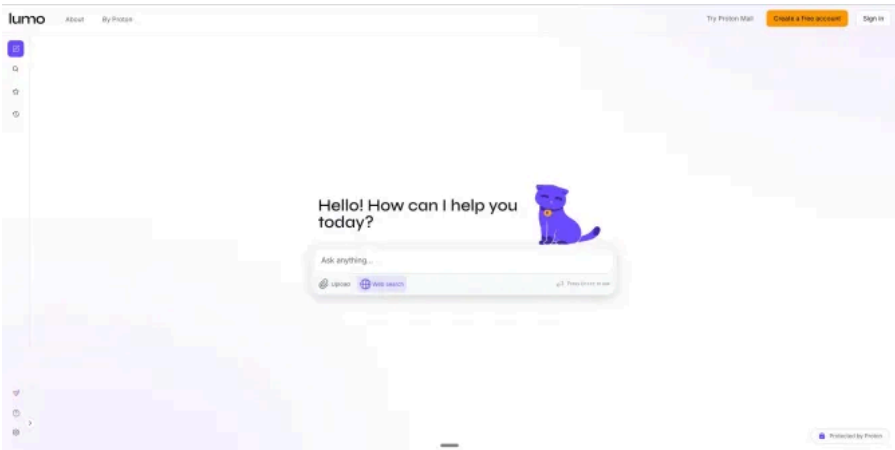


IMAGE CREDITS:SCREENSHOT BY TECHCRUNCH

Proton seems intent on making it clear that its focus is on privacy. The company says Lumo is based on open source models, and it will only depend on them for research and development going forward without utilizing user data to train its models. It also said Lumo relies on zero-access encryption, an encryption method that other Proton products also use, to let users store their conversation history, which can be decrypted on the device.

Throughout its [blog post about Lumo](#), Proton emphasized its European base, saying it gives the company a leg up over AI companies based in the U.S. and China when it comes to privacy.

Never uses your data to train AI	✔	✖	✖	✖	✖
Deletes all logs of your chats	✔	✖	✖	✖	✖
Can't share your data with anyone	✔	✖	✖	✖	✖
Has an ad-free business model	✔	✖	✖	✔	✖
Based in a high-privacy jurisdiction	✔	✖	✖	✖	✖
Opens source code to the public	✔	✖	✖	✖	✔
Start a chat					

IMAGE CREDITS:PROTON.ME

“Lumo is based upon open-source language models and operates from Proton’s European

Sarah Perez - 12 hours ago

AI



Google takes on ChatGPT’s Study Mode with new ‘Guided Learning’ tool in Gemini

Aisha Malik - 12 hours ago

datacenters. This gives you much greater transparency into the way Lumo works than any other major AI assistant. Unlike Apple Intelligence and others, Lumo is not a partnership with OpenAI or other American or Chinese AI companies, and your queries are never sent to any third parties,” Proton said.

This is not Proton’s first foray into the fast-developing AI tools space: Last year, it rolled out [an AI-powered writing assistant for its Mail product](#) that also runs on the user’s device.



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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously...

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Tumblr Gets More Secure With Addition Of Two-Factor Authentication

Sarah Perez — 11:38 AM PDT · March 24, 2014

Tumblr today [added](#) a very important security feature to its service, with the addition of two-factor authentication – an option available within the blogging service’s “Settings” section as of now. The move sees Tumblr at last joining the ranks of other

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top tech companies, including Facebook, Google, LinkedIn and Twitter, the [majority](#) of which offer some sort of two-factor authentication in order to provide an extra layer of security and protection for user accounts, making them less vulnerable to unauthorized access by hackers.

Two-factor authentication, for those who don't understand what that means, is a blanket term describing a method involving two stages (factors) for verifying a user's identity. Simply put, it means you need two things in order to prove you are who you say you are – not just a username and password. One typical scenario would involve a user providing something they know, like a password, combined with something they have, like a cell phone tied to a verified phone number.

In Tumblr's case, the cell phone scenario is exactly the method they're using. On the Account Settings page, users can first step up two-factor authentication by doing the following:

Click "Enable" next the new Two-Factor setting

Enter your cell phone number and Tumblr password

Decide if you want to get the code via text message or an authenticator app (like Google Authenticator). Or both.

Follow the steps on the Settings page to complete the process, which includes configuring two-factor for your Tumblr mobile apps.

After setup is complete, you'll then need to provide the authentication code at the time of login in an additional field below the username and password box on the web (see screenshot above). On mobile, you'll also need to generate a special one-time password in order to log in through your mobile apps on iOS or Android, Tumblr notes.

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Unfortunately, in initial tests, we had some difficulties getting Tumblr to accept the provided code, and attempts at having the code re-sent failed, implying there could still be some kinks in to work out here. [*Update*: after waiting a bit and trying a third time, the system worked flawlessly.]

Tumblr users with two-factor authentication switched on will immediately be less vulnerable to attacks and hacking attempts. While nothing will absolutely protect you from someone determined to gain unauthorized access to your account on Tumblr or anywhere else, two-factor authentication makes it much harder, as the would-be hacker would need both your username and password, and physical access to your phone to proceed.

Tumblr until recently was one of the few companies cited on TwoFactorAuth.org, a website that lists which services support two-factor (abbreviated 2FA), and which methods they offer – like SMS, Google Auth, [Authy](#), or another custom method. Most of the big-name tech companies – at least in the social space – either support 2FA or have it in development, like Reddit, noted as being “in progress.” Tumblr, however, was the only social service listed that was noted as lacking 2FA altogether.

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More info on the new feature is available [here](#) on Tumblr’s website.

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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [Twitter](#) [Email](#) [LinkedIn](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having...

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